

Sakinah — Identity Verification (KYC)

What this must achieve, and the boundaries. Not a how-to.

Verification is the price of a safe room. Its job is to make Sakinah a space of **real, unique, of-age people** — while never exposing anyone's identity to anyone else.

What the KYC step must achieve

- **Confirm a real person behind a government ID.** Verify a government identity document and a **liveness / face-match** (proves the user is live and is the same person as the ID).
- **Keep almost nothing.** Extract and store **only name, age, and gender**. **Never store the raw Aadhaar number.** Encrypt whatever you do keep.
- **Never expose identity to a match.** Verified identity data is for the system only — it is never shown to another user.
- **Gate entry, and keep banned people out.** A user is not matchable until verified, and a banned identity must not be able to return under a new account.
- **Be humane on failure.** A low liveness/face-match score goes to **human review** — never an automatic hard reject (face-match is less accurate for darker skin and for women in hijab).

Provided to you

You will be given **sandbox credentials for a KYC vendor** (covering government ID + liveness/face-match). Build and test the entire flow against that sandbox — you do not need, and must not use, real identity data in development. Obtaining the live production vendor account is handled separately, not by you.

The boundaries

- **Server-side only.** The backend performs and records verification; the client never decides whether someone is “verified.”
- **Data minimisation.** Collect the least you can, keep the least you can, and be ready to delete it. You are handling sensitive personal data — treat it that way.
- **No real PII in dev.** Sandbox only.

How to build it is yours to figure out

This brief intentionally does not specify the vendor, the endpoints, the consent flow, or the storage design. Work those out from the vendor's documentation and your own foundation document. Ask only if a **requirement or boundary above** is unclear.